

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 6 ♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦ 5

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6 ♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦ 4

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 7 ♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦ J

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6 ♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣ 7

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣ 10

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 6 ♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥ 5

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 4 2
 ♥ 5 2
 ♦ K 10 9 4 3 2
 ♣ 9 7 2

♠ A J 9 6 3

♥ A 4

♦ A Q J 6

♣ K 5



♠ 10 7
 ♥ K Q 10 9 8 7
 ♦ 5
 ♣ 10 8 6 3

♠ K Q 8 5

♥ J 6 3

♦ 8 7

♣ A Q J 4

When SOUTH gives immediate ♠ support, NORTH's thoughts naturally turn to slam. This is a good hand to use Blackwood on, so NORTH bids 4NT.

SOUTH's 5♦ answer shows one Ace, which NORTH cleverly deduces must be the ♣A.

NORTH bids 6♠ since SOUTH has not bid strongly enough to think about 7.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♠
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♣
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by North			
Lead: ♦5			

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q J
 ♥ A K 10
 ♦ K Q 2
 ♣ K Q 7 3

♠ 10 8 5 3

♥ 6 5

♦ A 7 5

♣ J 8 6 5



♠ A 6 4
 ♥ Q J 9 8 7 4
 ♦ J 9 8 3
 ♣ -

♠ 9 7 2

♥ 3 2

♦ 10 6 4

♣ A 10 9 4 2

WEST expects to bid 2NT at his second turn, but EAST gives a positive 2♥ response and his thinking changes! First he supports ♥s, setting the trump suit.

EAST then bids 3♠, showing first round control. WEST tries 4NT (Blackwood) and EAST replies 6♣. This shows a ♣ void and one Ace, obviously the ♠A.

WEST bids 6♥, knowing they must lose the ♦A.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	3♠	Pass
4NT	Pass	6♣	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			
6♥ by East			
Lead: ♦4			

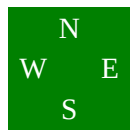
Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J 6
 ♥ 9 2
 ♦ J 5
 ♣ K 8 7 5 4 2

♠ A 8 4 2
 ♥ Q J 8 6
 ♦ A 9 8 6 3
 ♣ -



♠ 10 9 7 3
 ♥ 4
 ♦ Q 10 4 2
 ♣ A Q 10 3

♠ K 5
 ♥ A K 10 7 5 3
 ♦ K 7
 ♣ J 9 6

NORTH's jump to 4♣ is a Splinter bid, at least 4-card ♥ support, at least opening hand, and a ♣ Singleton or Void.

SOUTH bids 4NT, Blackwood.

NORTH's 5NT reply shows two Aces and a Void somewhere, obviously ♣s.

SOUTH counts thirteen tricks and bids 7♥.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1♥
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT
Pass	5NT	Pass	7♥
All Pass			
7♥ by South			
Lead: ♦J			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 5 3

♥ K Q J 10 3

♦ A

♣ K Q 10 6

♠ Q 10 7 2

♥ 4 2

♦ Q J 5 3 2

♣ 7 4



♠ -

♥ A 9 7 5

♦ K 9 8 6 4

♣ J 9 3 2

♠ A J 9 8 6 4

♥ 8 6

♦ 10 7

♣ A 8 5

WEST figures that if EAST holds two Aces he will bid the slam.

EAST only has one Ace, but she has something else just as good - a void in a suit which is higher-ranking than ♥s.

WEST manages to figure out that EAST has a ♠ void and bids the slam anyway.

West

1 ♥

4NT

All Pass

6 ♥ by West

Lead: ♣7

North

Pass

Pass

East

3 ♥

6 ♥

South

Pass

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 2
♥ 5 4 2
♦ Q J 3 2
♣ A Q 5 2

♠ A 9 8 6 4

♥ A K Q

♦ 7

♣ K J 6 3



♠ Q J

♥ 10 9 6 3

♦ K 10 9 4

♣ 10 9 8

♠ K 7 5 3

♥ J 8 7

♦ A 8 6 5

♣ 7 4

NORTH may have a good hand but SOUTH merely gave a simple raise. Even if SOUTH has a maximum there won't be a slam.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♣ 10

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 7 5 3
♥ 10 9 4 2
♦ A 8
♣ K J 4

♠ A 10 9 4 2

♥ A 7

♦ 10 5 4

♣ 9 7 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ -

♥ K Q J 8 6 3

♦ K J 2

♣ A Q 6 5

♠ K J 8 6

♥ 5

♦ Q 9 7 6 3

♣ 10 8 2

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

Pass

4♣

Pass

4♦

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by East

Lead: ♥5

EAST has a tough decision after the two
Control-showing bids.

If he uses Blackwood and WEST shows two Aces he
will be no better off, because he won't know if one of
the Aces is the useless ♠A. Based on knowing that
WEST holds the ♦A, he bids 6♥, hoping that he can
at least make that and that 7 isn't a laydown!